

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/25: The central question and the two rival answers

CENTRAL QUESTION: HOW CAN MANY CHANGING THINGS SHARE ONE KNOWABLE CHARACTER?

|

+--> ONE-MANY (hen epi pollon): many just acts -> one standard of Justice

+--> KNOWLEDGE: episteme needs an object that CANNOT BE OTHERWISE

+--> VALUE: the objectivity of "beautiful", "just", "good"

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TWO ANSWERS TO ONE QUESTION

|                                   |                                       |  |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------|--|
| +-----+-----+-----+               |                                       |  |
| PLATO                             | ARISTOTLE                             |  |
| SEPARATE the character from the   | KEEP the character INSIDE the thing   |  |
| thing: transcendent Form (eidos)  | immanent essence (to ti en einai)     |  |
| particulars PARTICIPATE(methexis) | substance = matter (hyle) informed by |  |
| or IMITATE (mimesis)              | form (morphe)                         |  |
| SUBSTANCE (ousia) = the universal | SUBSTANCE = this individual (tode ti) |  |
| CAUSE = paradigm + the Good       | CAUSE = four aitiai + internal telos  |  |
| CHANGE = sensible becoming        | CHANGE = dynamis -> energeia          |  |
| APEX = the Form of the Good       | APEX = the Unmoved Mover, pure act    |  |
| +-----+-----+-----+               |                                       |  |

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+--> COST TO PLATO: separation leaves participation UNANALYSED

+--> COST TO ARISTOTLE: immanent form INHERITS the universals problem

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MNEMONIC: PLATO POINTS UP; ARISTOTLE POINTS HERE.

SYLLABUS (verbatim): "Plato and Aristotle : Ideas; Substance; Form and Matter; Causation; Actuality and Potentiality." Paper I, Section A, item 1.

CORPUS SIGNAL: 12 primary-owned parts of 112 Western parts, with at least one part in EVERY year of the 2018-2025 corpus.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/25: Chronology and the textual map that prevents anachronism

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c.470-399 BCE  SOCRATES    "what is F itself?" - the search for definitions
|
c.428-348 BCE  PLATO       pupil of Socrates; Academy founded c.387 BCE
|
+-- EARLY dialogues    -> Socratic search for definitions
+-- MIDDLE dialogues   -> Meno, Phaedo: recollection, equality, the soul
|                       Republic V-VII: knowledge/opinion, Forms, the
|                       Good, Sun, Line, Cave, dialectic
+-- LATE dialogues     -> Parmenides: participation dilemma, regress
                        Sophist: being/non-being, highest kinds
                        Timaeus: Demiurge, paradigms, Receptacle
|
c.384-322 BCE  ARISTOTLE   enters the Academy c.367 BCE, stays ~20 YEARS;
|                       founds the Lyceum c.335 BCE
+-- Categories          -> primary/secondary substance, predication
+-- Physics I-III       -> form/matter/privation, four causes, change
+-- Metaphysics I       -> the critique of separated Forms
+-- Metaphysics VII-VIII (Z-H) -> substance, essence, matter/form
+-- Metaphysics IX (Theta) -> potentiality and actuality
+-- Metaphysics XII (Lambda) -> the Unmoved Mover, pure actuality
+-- De Anima II.1       -> the soul as the FORM OF THE LIVING BODY
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CONSEQUENCE: the critique is an INTERNAL demolition of a teacher's system,  
not an attack from a rival school.

CAUTION 1: dialogue chronology and developmental readings are DISPUTED.

Attribute an argument to ITS dialogue, not to one flat "two-world theory".

CAUTION 2: the Parmenides objections are PLATO'S OWN. The theory was under  
pressure before Aristotle wrote a line against it.

CAUTION 3: Aristotle's "substance" answers DIFFERENT questions in the  
Categories and the Metaphysics; never silently flatten one into the other.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/25: What a Form is – five properties and two cautions

FORM (eidos, idea) = eternal | immutable | non-material | self-identical | separate

| PROPERTY       | WHY PLATO NEEDS IT                               |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| eternal        | only what cannot be otherwise can be known       |
| immutable      | a changing standard would not fix a predicate    |
| non-material   | one Form must serve indefinitely many instances  |
| self-identical | sensibles are F and not-F in different relations |
| separate       | the standard must not depend on what it corrects |

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+--> THE FORM OF BEAUTY IS BEAUTY *ITSELF* - not any beautiful thing,
|     but that by virtue of which all beautiful things are beautiful
|
+--> THE GOOD (Republic VI 508b-509c) gives the other Forms BOTH their
      BEING and their KNOWABILITY, as the sun gives visible things both
      growth and visibility; itself "beyond being"
      (epekeina tes ousias, 509b)

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## TWO-LEVEL ONTOLOGY

|                                |  |                               |
|--------------------------------|--|-------------------------------|
| INTELLIGIBLE (noeton)          |  | SENSIBLE (horaton)            |
| eternal, unchanging            |  | temporal, in flux             |
| grasped by reason (nous)       |  | taken by opinion (doxa)       |
| the truly real (ontos on)      |  | derivative - copies, shadows  |
| object of knowledge (episteme) |  | object of belief (pistis) and |
|                                |  | conjecture (eikasia)          |

CAUTION 1: "intelligible realm" is a STRUCTURAL expression, not a place.

A spaceless entity cannot be SOMEWHERE.

CAUTION 2: Forms are NOT concepts in minds. That is CONCEPTUALISM, which

Plato rejects: the Form must be the standard by which minds are corrected.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/25: The four arguments for the Forms

| ARGUMENT                          | STRUCTURE                                                                                                                   | SOURCE                            |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| ONE-OVER-MANY<br>(hen epi pollon) | many beautiful things share a<br>common character -> there must be<br>one thing they all share                              | Republic V;<br>Parmenides 132a    |
| FROM KNOWLEDGE                    | knowledge requires an unchanging<br>object; the sensible world is in<br>flux; so its objects are<br>non-sensible universals | Republic V-VII;<br>cf. Theaetetus |
| FROM OPPOSITES /<br>RELATIVITY    | a stick is longer than X and<br>shorter than Y; sensibles<br>"participate in opposites"; the<br>Large itself is never small | Phaedo 74a-75d                    |
| RECOLLECTION<br>(anamnesis)       | we recognise equality in<br>sensibles though we never meet<br>perfect equality -> the soul knew<br>the Form before birth    | Phaedo 72e-77a;<br>Meno 80d-86c   |

---> THE FIRST TWO ARE LOAD-BEARING: unity + stability.

---> RECOLLECTION IS ONE SUPPORTING ROUTE, NOT PLATO'S WHOLE  
EPISTEMOLOGY. Reducing Platonic knowledge to remembering loses  
the dialectical ascent of Republic VI-VII entirely.

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BOUNDED SOUL-LINK: the soul's prior acquaintance and its capacity for noesis  
enter here only as an ARGUMENT FOR THE FORMS. The tripartite soul,  
immortality proofs beyond recollection, justice and the philosopher-ruler  
belong to ethics/politics and are NOT owner content under this clause.

TRAP: introducing Forms to "explain change" INVERTS the doctrine. Forms  
explain stability and intelligibility DESPITE change; explaining change  
is Aristotle's project.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/25: Timeless, spaceless, and what Plato's substance is

PYQ 2025 Q1(a): "Ideas are timeless and spaceless." ELUCIDATE = DERIVE, not assert.

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NON-MATERIAL -----> no magnitude, shape or position => SPACELESS  
| the Form of Justice is not "somewhere"  
SELF-IDENTICAL -----> no generation, destruction or alteration  
| => TIMELESS

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ADMITS OF NO OTHERWISE -> hence a proper object of KNOWLEDGE (episteme)

|  
+--> CONTRAST: particulars are temporal, spatial, changeable ->  
| objects only of OPINION (doxa)  
|  
+--> DISTINCTION FEW CANDIDATES DRAW:  
TIMELESS is not EVERLASTING. An everlasting thing lasts through  
all time; a timeless thing is one to which temporal predicates  
DO NOT APPLY AT ALL.

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SUBSTANCE FOR PLATO (ousia) = THE FORM  
the truly real is the UNIVERSAL; particulars have being only DERIVATIVELY,  
by participation. This is the EXACT INVERSION of Aristotle's position and  
the examiner exploits it constantly.

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EVALUATION TO CLOSE WITH: the property is the theory's strength AND its wound.  
What lifts Forms above flux also removes them from the spatio-temporal  
order they are meant to explain - Aristotle's charge at Metaphysics I.9.

|  
TRAP 1: "Plato denies the reality of the physical world" -> FALSE. He grants  
DERIVATIVE reality: copies, not illusions. He is not an illusionist, and a  
comparison with Advaita's maya is safe only if the difference is stated.

TRAP 2: answering the 2025 question with adjectives - "eternal, unchanging,  
perfect" - instead of the derivation.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/25: The Sun and the Divided Line

SUN (Republic VI 507a-509c): as the sun gives visible things VISIBILITY and GENERATION, the Good gives the Forms KNOWABILITY and BEING.

DIVIDED LINE (Republic VI 509d-511e): cut a line into two UNEQUAL parts - visible and intelligible - then cut each again IN THE SAME RATIO.

The four segments stand in CLARITY AND TRUTH (sapheneia, aletheia) exactly as their objects stand in DEGREE OF BEING.

| SEG | STATE (pathema)                  | OBJECTS                                                                    | METHOD                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A   | NOESIS<br>intellection<br>(nous) | THE FORMS, culminating in<br>THE GOOD                                      | DIALECTIC: treats<br>hypotheses AS<br>hypotheses, ascends<br>to an UNHYPOTHETICAL<br>first principle<br>(arche anhypothetos),<br>descends through<br>Forms alone, USING<br>NO IMAGES WHATEVER |
| B   | DIANOIA<br>thought               | MATHEMATICAL OBJECTS                                                       | (i) USES visible<br>things AS IMAGES -<br>the drawn triangle<br>stands for the<br>triangle<br>(ii) argues DOWNWARD<br>from hypotheses<br>"taken as known"                                     |
| C   | PISTIS belief                    | the VISIBLE THINGS: living<br>creatures, plants,<br>artefacts              | ordinary perception<br>and trust                                                                                                                                                              |
| D   | EIKASIA conjecture               | IMAGES: shadows,<br>reflections in water and<br>polished surfaces(eikones) | taking images for<br>their originals                                                                                                                                                          |

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/25: The Line's decisive discriminator and its cuts

PRIMARY CUT:  $D + C = \text{DOXA (opinion)}$  ||  $B + A = \text{EPISTEME (knowledge)}$

The further cuts are SUBDIVISIONS of each, not a second primary division.

MNEMONIC:  $E - P - D - N \leftrightarrow \text{Images} \mid \text{Things} \mid \text{Mathematicals} \mid \text{Forms}$

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### THE MOST EXAMINABLE SINGLE POINT

What separates DIANOIA from NOESIS is NOT the difficulty of the subject matter but the DIRECTION OF ARGUMENT and the USE OF IMAGES.

|                                |                                        |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| +-----+                        |                                        |
| MATHEMATICS (dianoia)          | DIALECTIC (noesis)                     |
| reasons DOWN from hypotheses   | reasons UP, destroying the hypotheses' |
| it "takes as known" and "gives | standing as starting-points, to an     |
| no account of" - the odd and   | UNHYPOTHETICAL first principle, then   |
| the even, the figures, the     | descends through Forms alone           |
| three kinds of angle           |                                        |
| USES diagrams as images        | USES NO IMAGES WHATEVER                |
| +-----+                        |                                        |

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+--> CONSEQUENCE: a hard theorem is still dianoia; an elementary piece  
of dialectic is still noesis. The criterion is METHODOLOGICAL.  
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### SCHOLARLY ASIDE (worth one clause, flag as contested)

It is a geometrical consequence of Plato's own instruction - cut in the same ratio - that the two MIDDLE segments, C and B, are NECESSARILY EQUAL in length whatever ratio is chosen. Plato never comments on this, and commentators disagree about whether it is significant.

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OBJECTION: the Line conflates KINDS of object with DEGREES of reality;

"more real" is not a coherent comparative.

REPLY: Plato's "more real" means more SELF-IDENTICALLY and UNQUALIFIEDLY what it is - a stick is long and short, the Long itself never is.

RESIDUE: Aristotle rejects the assumption outright at Metaphysics I.9 - being is said in MANY WAYS, not in DEGREES.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/25: The Cave – the Line narrated as an education

CAVE (Republic VII 514a-517a)

| STAGE                                                                                                                                                                              | SEGMENT                   | WHAT IS GRASPED                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| prisoners chained from childhood, facing the wall, seeing SHADOWS cast by a fire behind a prisoner is released, turns, sees THE FIRE and the CARRIED ARTEFACTS casting the shadows | EIKASIA<br>PISTIS         | images taken for realities<br>the visible originals |
| dragged up the rough ascent into daylight; bears at first only SHADOWS AND REFLECTIONS IN WATER of real things                                                                     | DIANOIA                   | intelligibles<br>approached<br>THROUGH images       |
| then the THINGS THEMSELVES; then stars and moon; finally THE SUN, and he infers that it governs all that is visible                                                                | NOESIS,<br>to the<br>GOOD | Forms directly,<br>and the Good as<br>their source  |

PLATO'S OWN INSTRUCTION (517a-b): apply the image "AS A WHOLE" to the Sun and the Line that precede it.

+--> ADDS 1: PAIN AND COMPULSION. "dragged up the steep and rugged ascent"; the eyes ache; at each stage he would prefer to return. EDUCATION (paideia) is NOT the insertion of knowledge into an empty soul but the TURNING AROUND (periagoge) of an organ of vision the soul ALREADY HAS - together with the whole soul.

+--> ADDS 2: THE RETURN (katabasis). He must go BACK DOWN, will see badly in the dark, will be ridiculed and "if they could lay hands on him" might be killed -> a transparent allusion to SOCRATES. This converts an epistemological allegory into the POLITICAL argument for philosopher-rulers.

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PRESUPPOSITIONS OF THE WHOLE TRIAD

- P1 degrees of reality correlate with degrees of cognitive clarity
- P2 the object determines the faculty (Republic V 476e-480a)
- P3 there is an unhypothetical first principle, or the ascent has no terminus
- P4 the soul already possesses the capacity for noesis (hence recollection)

POLITICAL GAP: from HAVING SEEN THE GOOD to BEING ENTITLED TO RULE.

Popper, The Open Society and Its Enemies, Vol. I (1945) attacks exactly here; widely regarded as polemical and contested by Plato scholars.  
The epistemology can be accepted WITHOUT the politics; Plato denied it.



## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/25: Participation and its two internal objections

RELATION: particulars PARTICIPATE (methexis) in / IMITATE (mimesis) the Form.

Form = PARADIGM | particular = COPY.

ONE PARTICULAR MAY PARTICIPATE IN SEVERAL FORMS AT ONCE.

PYQ 2021 Q1(a) "there is a red chair" -> Chair AND Redness, and neither Form becomes a physical part of the chair.

|  
+--> OBJECTION 1: THE PARTICIPATION DILEMMA (Parmenides 131a-c)

|     whole Form in each participant? -> it is "separated from itself"  
|     only a PART in each?           -> the Form is divisible, and a  
|                                       divided Form of SMALLNESS  
|                                       would make its participant  
|                                       LARGE by comparison

|     REPLY AVAILABLE: the dilemma assumes Forms behave like  
|     EXTENDED BODIES; a spaceless entity arguably does not.

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+--> OBJECTION 2: THE REGRESS (Parmenides 132a-b; example = largeness)

|     PREMISE 1 SELF-PREDICATION: the Form of F is itself F

|     PREMISE 2 NON-IDENTITY: the Form explaining a resemblance must  
|                                       be DISTINCT from the particular and from the first Form

|     -> men + Form of Man also resemble -> a SECOND Form is required

|     -> and a third, and so on AD INFINITUM

|     NAME: "Third Man" comes from ARISTOTLE'S REPORTS

|                       (Metaphysics 990b17, 1039a2) and later commentators.

|     The ARGUMENT is Plato's own.

|     ESCAPE ROUTE: deny PREMISE 1 - the Form of Large is not "large"  
|     in the same sense a mountain is - and STEP 1 never starts.

|  
+--> OBJECTION 3: CAUSAL IMPOTENCE. A changeless, non-spatial,  
|     separated Form cannot be an EFFICIENT cause of change in  
|     spatial, temporal things. Participation and imitation remain  
|     METAPHORS without a causal mechanism.

|     >>> THIS ONE SURVIVES EVERY ESCAPE ROUTE <<<

|  
STATUS OF THE LATER DIALOGUES: whether the Sophist (communion of kinds) and  
|     the Timaeus (ordered becoming) RESOLVE these difficulties, or merely revise  
|     the theory, is CONTESTED. Do not assert that Plato abandoned the Forms.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/25: Plato's wider causal resources and the accurate objection

| CONTEXT                         | EXPLANATORY ROLE                                                              | LIMITATION                                                         |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Forms in the PHAEDO             | a thing is beautiful because of Beauty, equal because of Equality             | gives FORMAL explanation but NO mechanism of motion                |
| The GOOD in the REPUBLIC        | grounds BEING and INTELLIGIBILITY; supplies an ultimate normative orientation | NOT simply a personal creator-God                                  |
| The DEMIURGE in the TIMAEUS     | orders becoming by LOOKING TO Forms as paradigms                              | crafts order; does NOT create Forms or the Receptacle from nothing |
| The RECEPTACLE (chora), TIMAEUS | the difficult "THIRD KIND" in which sensible becoming appears                 | NOT straightforwardly identical with Aristotle's matter            |

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 +--> PLATO THEREFORE HAS MORE THAN "FORMS AS ONE CAUSE".

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STATE THE OBJECTION IN ITS ACCURATE FORM

NOT: "Plato has no causes" <- false, easily rebutted

BUT: "SEPARATED FORMS THEMSELVES do not explain motion, generation or the internal organisation of this substance" <- true, hard to rebut

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VERDICT FORMULA FOR THE 2018 QUESTION

The relation is NOT PROVEN INCONSISTENT: the regress needs self-predication, which Plato may deny, and the whole-or-part dilemma assumes extension, which a spaceless Form lacks.

But it is EXPLANATORILY EMPTY: a relation that cannot be SPECIFIED cannot do explanatory work - and the Timaeus pays that debt with a NEW ENTITY rather than with an ANALYSIS of participation.

DO NOT: equate the Form of the Good with the Demiurge. Their relation across dialogues is interpretively CONTESTED.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/25: Aristotle's five objections to separated Forms

SOURCE: Metaphysics I.9 and XIII.4-5. ~20 years in the Academy = INTERNAL critique.

| # | OBJECTION                   | KERNEL                                                                                             | NEEDS SELF-PREDICATION? |
|---|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1 | THIRD MAN REGRESS           | self-predication + separation -> an infinite regress of Forms                                      | YES                     |
| 2 | DUPLICATION                 | separated Forms merely DOUBLE the things to be explained - "two sets of entities instead of one"   | NO                      |
| 3 | PARTICIPATION IS A METAPHOR | Plato never SPECIFIES the relation; it is a poetic word                                            | NO                      |
| 4 | CAUSAL IMPOTENCE            | unchanging, separated, non-spatial Forms cannot be EFFICIENT causes                                | NO                      |
| 5 | NO ACCOUNT OF GENERATION    | Forms are eternal; the real demand is for COMING-TO-BE and PASSING-AWAY, on which Forms are silent | NO                      |

+---> DECISIVE CONSEQUENCE: blocking self-predication saves Plato from  
 OBJECTION 1 ONLY. Objections 2-5 survive untouched.

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STACE'S REPORT OF ARISTOTLE'S TWO SHARPEST FORMULATIONS

- (i) as "deified men" are nothing but men made divine, so "the Ideas are nothing but eternalized things of nature"; things are said to be copies of Ideas, but in fact the Ideas are only copies of things.
- (ii) the theory "assumes that Ideas are the essences of things, and yet places those essences OUTSIDE the things themselves." The essence of a thing must be IN it, and not outside it.

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KEEP THE FIVE DISTINCT. A merged blur earns one mark where five separated arguments earn several. Each must be stated with the premise it needs.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/25: The immanent repair – what is kept, what is deleted

THE REPAIR IN ONE SENTENCE: KEEP THE eidos, DELETE THE SEPARATION.

Form becomes the IMMANENT ESSENCE - the what-it-is-to-be (to ti en einai) - of THIS concrete composite.

|                                |                                        |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| +-----+-----+                  |                                        |
| RETAINED                       | DELETED                                |
| the WORD eidos                 | separate existence of the Form         |
| intelligible structure as the  | the PRIORITY of the universal over the |
| source of a thing's being what | individual                             |
| it is                          | the paradigm-copy relation             |
| species and genus as SECONDARY | Forms as objects in a second order of  |
| SUBSTANCES                     | reality                                |
| +-----+-----+                  |                                        |

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|                                  |                                        |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| +-----+-----+                    |                                        |
| WHAT THE REPAIR BUYS             | WHAT IT COSTS                          |
| NO REGRESS: with no separation,  | Form must be INTELLIGIBLE and hence in |
| the Form-particular resemblance  | some sense UNIVERSAL - yet Metaphysics |
| never arises                     | VII (Z).13 denies that ANY universal   |
| REAL CAUSATION: immanent form    | is a substance                         |
| is the actuality that the matter | INDIVIDUAL vs SPECIES FORM remains     |
| is potentially                   | CONTESTED (Frede-Patzig vs Owen)       |
| GENERATION EXPLAINED: matter     | PRIME MATTER, needed for radical       |
| can lose one form and acquire    | generation, is a limiting posit whose  |
| another                          | textual standing is DISPUTED           |
| UNITY: the composite is ONE      | matter and form are CORRELATIVE and    |
| thing, not two joined            | cannot be defined independently        |
| +-----+-----+                    |                                        |

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TRAP: "Aristotle rejected the Forms" / "Aristotle denies universals" -> FALSE.

He rejects SEPARATED Forms and the priority of the universal.

Species and genus survive as SECONDARY substances.

ANSWER LINE: he DEFEATS SEPARATION, NOT FORM. Plato's insight - that

intelligibility may require something beyond this particular - is ANSWERED rather than REFUTED, which is why the dispute is not settled in antiquity but becomes the medieval problem of universals.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/25: Substance – one word, two questions, two criteria

|                                |                                           |  |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|--|
| CATEGORIES 2a11 ff.            | METAPHYSICS VII (Z)                       |  |
| "WHICH THINGS ARE SUBSTANCES?" | "WHAT IS THE SUBSTANCE *OF* A THING?"     |  |
| criterion: LOGICAL-LINGUISTIC  | criterion: CAUSAL-EXPLANATORY             |  |
| the ultimate SUBJECT of        | what makes it BE what it is               |  |
| predication                    |                                           |  |
| PRIMARY SUBSTANCE = the        | SUBSTANCE = FORM / ESSENCE                |  |
| concrete individual (tode ti): | (eidos, to ti en einai)                   |  |
| "this man", "this horse"       | essence is PRIOR to the compound in       |  |
|                                | being, definition and knowledge           |  |
| SECONDARY SUBSTANCE = species  | THE COMPOUND (synolon) is substance, but  |  |
| and genus ("man", "animal") -  | FORM has priority: it is what MAKES the   |  |
| said OF the primary, LESS REAL | thing what it is                          |  |
| MATTER: not discussed          | MATTER: REJECTED as substance at Z.3 -    |  |
|                                | neither separable nor a "this"            |  |
| everything else is said OF a   | THE STING: Z.13 "NO UNIVERSAL IS A        |  |
| primary substance or is IN it  | SUBSTANCE" - yet form is a substance, and |  |
|                                | form looks universal                      |  |

+--> THE REVERSAL OF PLATO: for Plato the UNIVERSAL is most real;  
| for Aristotle the INDIVIDUAL is most real.

+--> DO NOT SILENTLY FLATTEN ONE USAGE INTO THE OTHER. The Metaphysics  
| does not cancel the Categories - it EXPLAINS WHY the individual is  
| a substance, namely because it has an essence.

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### FURTHER CONTROLS

A universal AS PREDICATED OF MANY is not a substance.

Whether substantial form is numerically INDIVIDUAL in each substance, or is  
the SPECIES-LEVEL essence grasped by science, is a MAJOR DISPUTE.

SAFE CLAIM: form is the immanent essence and explanatory principle of the  
concrete composite.

THE UNMOVED MOVER is pure form and actuality without matter, but it is NOT  
the substantial form of every sensible thing.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 14/25: Z.3 candidates, Z.17's reformulation, four readings

### METAPHYSICS VII (Z).3 - FOUR CANDIDATES FOR SUBSTANCE, WITH VERDICTS

| CANDIDATE                    | VERDICT                                  |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| SUBSTRATUM (hypokeimenon) as | (a) REJECTED: strip away every           |
| (a) matter                   | predicate and what remains is NOT a      |
| (b) form                     | "this" and is NOT separable              |
| (c) the compound             | (b) and (c) REMAIN IN PLAY               |
| ESSENCE (to ti en einai)     | ACCEPTED - the leading answer of         |
|                              | Z.4-6 and Z.17                           |
| UNIVERSAL                    | REJECTED at Z.13                         |
| GENUS                        | REJECTED - a genus is predicated of many |

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### Z.17 - THE DECISIVE REFORMULATION

Substance is sought as a CAUSE. The question is not "WHAT is this?" but "WHY IS THIS MATTER A HOUSE?" - and the answer is THE FORM.

Substance is therefore an EXPLANATORY PRINCIPLE, not merely the bearer of properties. This is what the Categories could not deliver.

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### FOUR AVAILABLE READINGS OF THE TENSION - NAME AT LEAST TWO

- 1 DIFFERENT QUESTIONS - two questions may have two answers without contradiction; Aristotle insists being is "said in many ways" [SAFEST]
- 2 DEVELOPMENTALIST (Jaeger) - the Categories is early and Platonic-adjacent [depends on a DISPUTED chronology]
- 3 INDIVIDUAL FORMS (Frede-Patzig) - the form that is substance is THIS soul, THIS organising principle; Z.13 then leaves form untouched [CONTESTED]
- 4 UNIVERSAL / SPECIES FORMS (Owen and others) - form is the species-form, so Z.13 creates a genuine APORIA Aristotle does not resolve [CONTESTED]

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EXECUTABLE VERDICT: "The CATEGORIES identifies the SUBSTANCES; the METAPHYSICS identifies SUBSTANCE-HOOD. The individual remains what exists in the primary way, but what accounts for its being the individual it is, is its FORM. The tension is real only if 'substance' must have a single sense - which Aristotle explicitly denies."

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 15/25: Substance and accident – the ten categories

| CATEGORY       | EXAMPLE               | STATUS               |
|----------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| SUBSTANCE      | "Socrates"            | exists independently |
| Quantity       | "six feet tall"       | depends on substance |
| Quality        | "pale"                | depends on substance |
| Relation       | "taller than Simmias" | depends on substance |
| Place          | "in the Lyceum"       | depends on substance |
| Time           | "yesterday"           | depends on substance |
| Position       | "sitting"             | depends on substance |
| State / having | "armed", "shod"       | depends on substance |
| Action         | "cuts"                | depends on substance |
| Being affected | "is cut"              | depends on substance |

|  
+--> SUBSTANCE \*IS\*; ACCIDENTS \*BELONG TO\* substance.  
|  
+--> CHANGE OF ACCIDENTS = ALTERATION  
+--> CHANGE OF SUBSTANCE = GENERATION / DESTRUCTION  
|  
v

TWO CONTROLS THAT EARN MARKS

- 1 The ten categories classify FUNDAMENTAL MODES OF PREDICATION AND BEING in the Categories. They are NOT ten physical components inside a substance. "Yesterday" and "taller than Simmias" are not ingredients.
- 2 ONLY SUBSTANCE can function as the underlying subject in the primary way; the other nine are IN, or SAID OF, substances.

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WHY THIS MATTERS FOR THE 2025 EVALUATION

Because accidents are not independent things, they are NOT themselves further matter-form compounds in the same sense. That is one of the three boundaries on the claim that "everything in the empirical world is a compound of Matter and Form".

TRAP: treating the categories as a physical inventory is a category mistake in the literal sense of the phrase.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 16/25: Hylomorphism, privation and prime matter

EVERY SENSIBLE NATURAL SUBSTANCE = COMPOUND (synolon) OF MATTER AND FORM

|                                |                                        |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| +-----+ +-----+                |                                        |
| MATTER (hyle)                  | FORM (morphe)                          |
| the "out of which", substratum | the structure / essence / actuality    |
| principle of POTENTIALITY      | makes the composite ONE thing          |
| bronze   wood   the body       | Hermes-shape   table-design   the soul |
| +-----+ +-----+                |                                        |

MATTER IS RELATIVE: copper + tin -> BRONZE -> STATUE. Bronze is matter for the statue but is itself a form imposed on copper and tin.

THE PAIR IS CORRELATIVE: matter is what has form; form is what informs matter. They are NOT two independently existing objects joined together.

STRONGEST CASES ARE LIVING SUBSTANCES, NOT ARTEFACTS: only there is form an internal principle of activity. SOUL = THE FORM OF THE LIVING BODY (De Anima II.1) - Aristotle's own leading illustration, not a substance lodged inside the body.

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CHANGE = UNDERLYING SUBJECT + ACQUIRED FORM + PRIOR PRIVATION (steresis)

the not-yet-musical person becomes musical: the SUBJECT persists (the person), the FORM is acquired (musical), the PRIVATION is removed

ACCIDENTAL CHANGE -> the SUBSTANTIAL FORM PERSISTS while quantity, quality, place or another accident changes

SUBSTANTIAL GENERATION -> an underlying material potential acquires a NEW substantial form; the PRIOR substantial form does NOT persist as the identity of the new substance

|  
+-->

THREE JOBS, THREE TOOLS

matter / form / privation -> the STRUCTURE of change

potentiality / actuality -> the MODAL TRANSITION

the four causes -> WHY this determinate process occurs

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PRIME MATTER (prote hyle) = a LIMITING POSIT of matter considered WITHOUT any determinate form. NEVER exists independently. How fully Aristotle commits to ONE featureless prime matter is DISPUTED.

CRITICISM: an unintelligible abstraction - matter with NO form?

REPLY: a LIMIT CONCEPT, never actual on its own, required to explain RADICAL generation in which no determinate matter survives.

DO NOT present it as an observed stuff or equate it with the Receptacle.

TRAP: saying "the form persists" of SUBSTANTIAL change destroys the very distinction on which the developmental-change answer depends.



## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 17/25: The four causes and internal teleology

TO KNOW A THING IS TO KNOW ITS CAUSES (aitiai). "Cause" here means "BECAUSE".

STACE: Aristotle's causation includes what we call REASONS as well as causes - whatever is necessary, whether facts or principles, "fully to understand the existence of a thing, or the happening of an event"; and "in every case of the existence or production of a thing all four causes operate simultaneously." Contrast MILL: a cause is the "invariable and unconditional antecedent of a phenomenon", which excludes final causes.

[Physics II.3]

| CAUSE        | QUESTION               | STATUE            | WOODEN TABLE                    |
|--------------|------------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------|
| MATERIAL     | made of what?          | bronze            | wood                            |
| FORMAL       | what is it?            | shape of Hermes   | the design "table"              |
| EFFICIENT    | what brought it about? | the sculptor      | the carpenter                   |
| FINAL(telos) | what is it FOR?        | to honour the god | a surface for dining or writing |

|

+--> ARTEFACT: the purpose is EXTERNAL, in the maker's mind. THIS IS A TEACHING CASE borrowed from a situation where intention is present.

|

+--> ORGANISM: FORMAL = EFFICIENT = FINAL CONVERGE on the mature form. acorn matter + oak-form + parent and nutrition + the mature oak. DIRECTEDNESS IS INTERNAL. THIS IS THE SERIOUS CASE.

|

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TELEOLOGY: "NATURE DOES NOTHING IN VAIN"

works: De Caelo, Politics, De Partibus Animalium - a RECURRING MAXIM.

MEANING: REGULARITY OF OUTCOMES - the acorn reliably becomes an oak and never a cat. NOT a claim that nature deliberates or plans.

It does NOT make material and efficient explanation dispensable.

MODERN TEST

DECISIVE against teleology in PHYSICS: motion is explained by efficient causation and law, with no final causes.

NOT decisive in BIOLOGY: functional explanation survives as adaptation, selective advantage and organ-function - DIRECTEDNESS WITHOUT DESIGN.

RESIDUAL WORRY: unless directedness is given independent content, "for the sake of" risks naming the outcome and calling it an explanation.

TRAPS: the four causes are NOT four EVENTS and NOT four AGENTS; run them through ONE worked example, never four different ones.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 18/25: Developmental change and identity as process

PYQ 2019 Q2(b): "REASONS for developmental changes in substance" = aitiai.

- 1 the substance has MATTER - the potential for receiving a new form
  - 2 an EFFICIENT cause initiates and sustains the process
  - 3 the change is directed toward a TELOS - the form it is on its way to
  - 4 the FORMAL cause specifies WHAT IT BECOMES
- => CHANGE = the ACTUALISATION OF MATTER'S POTENTIALITY UNDER THE DIRECTION OF THE FINAL CAUSE. This binds causation directly to potency-act.  
STRUCTURE OF THE CHANGE ITSELF: subject + acquired form + privation.  
TWO KINDS: accidental (substance survives) | substantial (new substance).

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PYQ 2022 Q2(b): IS IDENTITY IN CONSONANCE WITH CAUSES AS PROCESSES?

- 1 IDENTITY is supplied by the SUBSTANTIAL FORM or essence: the form answers WHAT THE THING IS. Metaphysics VII (Z).17: substance sought as a cause.
- 2 MATTER supplies determinate CAPACITIES for change, not a second identity.
- 3 EFFICIENT causation initiates or transmits; FINAL causation names the completed actuality toward which development is ordered.
- 4 During ACCIDENTAL change the same substantial form persists; during SUBSTANTIAL generation a new form constitutes a NEW substance.
- 5 => CONSONANT, and for a STRUCTURAL reason: the SAME FORM does both jobs - it states what the thing is AND is the actuality its potential moves to.

|

EXAMPLE 1 THE OAK: acorn matter has the potential for oak-form; parent and nutrition supply efficient causation; oak-form is both what it becomes and what the growth is FOR. Throughout, it remains this developing organism.

EXAMPLE 2 THE BRONZE: casting is ACCIDENTAL change to the bronze, which persists; the coming-to-be of a living thing is SUBSTANTIAL generation.

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OBJECTION: defining a process by its COMPLETED FORM reads the end back into the beginning and understates contingency and failed development.

REPLY: a potentiality is always a capacity of THIS material under THESE conditions - not a guarantee that every process reaches completion.

VERDICT: Aristotle integrates identity and becoming MORE SUCCESSFULLY than a static essence theory - but the integration is purchased with INTERNAL TELEOLOGY, and that is the doctrine's real price.

CONTRAST WITH PLATO: Forms are formal/paradigmatic causes; the Good is the highest principle; the Timaeus adds a Demiurge. Aristotle's scheme places EVERY explanatory factor INSIDE ONE PROCESS.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 19/25: Potentiality, actuality and the Eleatic dilemma

DYNAMIS -----> KINESIS -----> ENERGEIA / ENTELECHEIA  
capacity of THIS matter    actualisation in progress fulfilment / completed state  
block of wood              -> cutting and joining         -> the finished table  
acorn                        -> organic development       -> the mature oak

DEFINITION OF CHANGE: "the actuality of the potential PRECISELY AS  
POTENTIAL"  
[Physics III.1, 201a10]

The qualifier is ESSENTIAL: without it the formula describes the finished  
result, not the process.

TERMS: ENERGEIA = the ACTIVITY | ENTELECHEIA = the COMPLETED STATE

|  
+--> "POTENTIALITY IS INDEFINABLE" [PYQ 2021 Q1(b), verbatim]  
| dynamis cannot be defined independently of energeia: "potentially  
| a table" presupposes that one knows what an ACTUAL table is.  
| Hence exposition proceeds by ANALOGY AND EXAMPLE, not by genus and  
| differentia. Actuality is CONCEPTUALLY PRIOR.  
|  
+--> TRAP: dynamis is an ONTOLOGICAL CAPACITY inherent in determinate  
matter - NOT a statistical probability.  
  
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## THE ANCIENT PROBLEM

PARMENIDES: being cannot come from non-being; being already IS; therefore there is NO becoming.

HERACLITUS: everything is in flux; there is NO stable being at all.

BOTH ASSUME ONLY TWO OPTIONS: BEING or NON-BEING.

↓  
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ARISTOTLE ADDS A THIRD STATUS: BEING-IN-POTENTIALITY

## ARISTOTLE ADDS A THIRD STATUS: BEING-IN-POTENTIALITY

the acorn is NOT an oak IN ACTUALITY but IS an oak IN POTENTIALITY

-> NO leap from ABSOLUTE non-being => Parmenides' principle RESPECTED

-> change is real and fundamental => Heraclitus' observation PRESERVED

-> stability is RELOCATED into the FORM toward which change is ordered

NOTE WHAT "SOLUTION" MEANS: Aristotle does not REFUTE Parmenides' logic;

he DENIES THE DICHOTOMY on which it rests. Writing that sentence is what separates a strong 2023 answer from an adequate one.

LIMITATION: the scheme is defined by reference to the actuality that terminates it, so it ILLUMINATES A PROCESS IT CANNOT PREDICT - explanatory modesty rather than a flaw, and the point at which mechanics parted company with it.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 20/25: Priority of actuality, priority of form, and pure act

### PRIORITY OF ACTUALITY OVER POTENTIALITY [Metaphysics IX (Theta)]

1 IN DEFINITION / LOGOS: to define "potentially F" you must first grasp what it is to ACTUALLY BE F

2 IN TIME, AT THE SPECIES LEVEL: only an ACTUAL oak produces acorns

3 IN SUBSTANCE / NATURE: the END is what the becoming is FOR; it is the *raison d'être* of the potentiality

CONCESSION TO MAKE OPENLY: in an INDIVIDUAL'S OWN HISTORY the potential state PRECEDES its actualisation. Priority is EXPLANATORY, DEFINITIONAL and TELEOLOGICAL - not temporal precedence in every sense.

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### PRIORITY OF FORM OVER MATTER [PYQ 2020 Q1(a): both priorities]

Matter is intelligible only as POTENTIAL FOR some determinate form; form is the WHAT-IT-IS-TO-BE that makes the composite what it is. Wood does not tell us what a table is; the functional structure does.

Metaphysics VII (Z).17: substance sought as a CAUSE - "why is this matter a house?" Form is prior in DEFINITION and in KNOWABILITY.

DO NOT translate priority into the claim that form exists EARLIER IN TIME than every material process.

|  
+--> THE TWO PRIORITIES ARE ONE DOCTRINE SEEN TWICE:  
FORM is ACTUALITY considered STRUCTURALLY;  
ACTUALITY is FORM considered MODALLY.  
|  
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### THE TERMINUS: THE UNMOVED MOVER [Metaphysics XII (Lambda).7]

PURE ACTUALITY (*actus purus*): NO unfulfilled potentiality whatsoever. With potentiality it would be subject to change and dependency.

MOVES AS A FINAL CAUSE: "moves as the beloved moves the lover" - it

ATTRACTS as the perfect object of desire and thought; it does NOT PUSH.

THOUGHT THINKING ITSELF (*noesis noeseos*): eternal self-contemplation, the highest actuality, intellectual in kind.

NOT: an efficient creator | a first EVENT in time | a material cause | the substantial form of every sensible thing | a conserving cause.

OBJECTION: can a final cause explain PHYSICAL motion?

REPLY: the cosmos is a system of desire oriented toward the divine, with sublunary efficient causes mediating; Neoplatonists and Aquinas adjust.

SCOPE DISCIPLINE: retained because pure actuality COMPLETES the actuality-potentiality and causal system - NOT as a philosophy-of-religion survey, and never with Paper II proofs imported.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 21/25: The comparison matrix and the criticism-reply ledger

ONE QUESTION DECIDES EVERYTHING: IS THE FORM INSIDE THE THING?

| AXIS                              | PLATO                                                                  | ARISTOTLE                                                       |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| location of form                  | transcendent, separate                                                 | immanent in the composite                                       |
| what is most real                 | the universal Form                                                     | the individual substance (tode ti)                              |
| relation to particulars           | participation / imitation                                              | hylomorphic constitution                                        |
| knowledge                         | dialectical grasp of Forms; recollection is ONE supporting argument    | begins from sensible particulars, reaches universal form/causes |
| change                            | sensible becoming vs stable Forms; the Timaeus adds ordered becoming   | potency -> act; the CENTRAL task                                |
| causation                         | Forms as paradigms; the Good; Demiurge/Receptacle                      | four causes; internal teleology                                 |
| highest principle                 | the Form of the Good ("beyond being")                                  | the Unmoved Mover, pure actuality                               |
| the universal matter              | the ousia, the truly real Receptacle / "third kind"                    | secondary substance correlative potency                         |
| AGAINST PLATO                     | REPLY AVAILABLE                                                        | RESIDUE                                                         |
| Third Man regress                 | -> deny self-predication [contested]                                   | -> the explanatory gap survives untouched                       |
| causal impotence                  | -> the Timaeus Demiurge orders after paradigms                         | -> a NEW ENTITY, not an analysis of participation               |
| duplication                       | -> Forms are not a second set but that which makes things intelligible | -> the debt is transferred, not paid                            |
| AGAINST ARISTOTLE                 | REPLY AVAILABLE                                                        | RESIDUE                                                         |
| prime matter unintelligible       | -> a LIMIT CONCEPT required for radical generation                     | -> never observable; commitment disputed                        |
| teleology is anthropomorphic      | -> directedness, not design; regularity of outcomes                    | -> needs independent content                                    |
| final cause cannot explain motion | -> cosmos as a system of desire; sublunary efficient causes mediate    | -> Neoplatonists and Aquinas must adjust                        |
| Categories vs Z inconsistency?    | -> different works, different questions                                | -> Z.13 aporia if form is the species-form                      |

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 22/25: The complete PYQ rail, 2018-2025

TWELVE PRIMARY-OWNED PARTS OF 112 WESTERN PARTS.

AT LEAST ONE PART IN EVERY YEAR OF THE 2018-2025 CORPUS.

- 2018 Q4(b) 15m Idea-World relation logically consistent? + Aristotle  
-> P9 + P10 + P11; verdict: not inconsistent, but empty
- 2019 Q1(a) 10m What does Plato want to prove by the Allegory of Cave?  
-> P8: Line mapping + periagoge + katabasis; three theses
- 2019 Q2(b) 15m Reasons for developmental changes in substance  
-> P17 aitiai + P16 privation + P18 the four steps
- 2020 Q1(a) 10m Priority of Form over Matter, Actuality over Potentiality  
-> P20 three senses + the individual-level concession
- 2021 Q1(a) 10m "There is a red chair" via the theory of forms  
-> P9 multiple participation + P5 derivative reality
- 2021 Q1(b) 10m "Potentiality is indefinable"; the wooden table  
-> P19 three stages: dynamis / kinesis / energeia
- 2022 Q1(a) 10m Forms linking epistemology and metaphysics  
-> P3 + P6 + P7: Rep. V 476e-480a, the Line, the Sun
- 2022 Q2(b) 15m Identity in consonance with causes as processes?  
-> P18 with the oak and the bronze, objection and reply
- 2023 Q2(b) 15m Actuality/potentiality: does it solve being and becoming?  
-> P19 Parmenides-Heraclitus and the third status
- 2024 Q1(a) 10m Differentiate Plato's and Aristotle's conceptions of form  
-> P21 ONE axis, matched contrasts, consequences
- 2025 Q1(a) 10m "Ideas are timeless and spaceless" - elucidate  
-> P5 DERIVE the property, then the epistemic payoff
- 2025 Q1(b) 10m "Everything is a compound of Matter and Form" - evaluate  
-> P16 doctrine + P15 accidents + the three exclusions

DEMAND PATTERN ACROSS THE CORPUS

PLATO-SIDE PARTS: 2018, 2019 Q1(a), 2021 Q1(a), 2022 Q1(a), 2025 Q1(a)

ARISTOTLE-SIDE PARTS: 2019 Q2(b), 2020, 2021 Q1(b), 2022 Q2(b), 2023,  
2025 Q1(b)

EXPLICITLY COMPARATIVE: 2018 (second limb) and 2024

NINE OF TWELVE ARE 10-MARK PARTS -> compression discipline decides the score.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 23/25: The answer spine, directive decoder and citation rule

ANSWER SPINE (the route never changes; only the number of items changes)

DIRECTIVE -> DEFINITION -> ARGUMENT -> EXAMPLE -> OBJECTION -> REPLY

-> GRADED VERDICT

10 marks, about 150-200 words: 1 + 2 + 1 + 1

15 marks, about 250-300 words: 1 + 3 + 2 + 2

20 marks, about 340-400 words: 1 + 4 + 3 + 3

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DIRECTIVE DECODER - WHAT EACH COMMAND WORD OBLIGES YOU TO DO

ELUCIDATE (2025 Q1a) -> DERIVE the property from the doctrine  
FATAL: restating "Forms are eternal"

EXPLAIN THE CAVE (2019) -> MAP onto the Line AND include the return  
FATAL: retelling the story

DIFFERENTIATE (2024) -> ONE axis, run consistently, then consequences  
FATAL: two parallel summaries

EXAMINE THE CRITIQUE -> each objection as an ARGUMENT + Plato's replies  
FATAL: a list of complaints without replies

DISCUSS THE FOUR CAUSES -> four "why" questions about ONE worked example  
FATAL: four definitions, four examples

ACTUALITY/POTENTIALITY -> show it SOLVES Parmenides, then priority, then  
the Mover

FATAL: defining dynamis and energeia only

SUBSTANCE IN ARISTOTLE -> the Categories/Z question + TWO named readings  
FATAL: "primary substance = the individual"

CRITICALLY EVALUATE -> a RULING IN LINE 1, then the evidence for it  
FATAL: balanced description with no verdict

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CITATION DISCIPLINE - both corpora have EDITION-INVARIANT reference systems

PLATO = STEPHANUS pagination: Republic 507a-509c (Sun), 509d-511e (Line),  
514a-517a (Cave), 596a (one-over-many); Phaedo 74a-75d, 72e-77a;  
Meno 80d-86c; Parmenides 131a-c, 132a-b

ARISTOTLE = BEKKER numbers: Categories 2a11; Metaphysics I.9 (990b),  
I.6 (987b14), VII (Z).3, Z.13, Z.17, XII (Lambda).7; Physics II.3,  
III.1 (201a10); De Anima II.1. GIVE BOTH CONVENTIONS ONCE: "Book VII (Z)"

TRANSLATIONS: Jowett 1871 (public domain, still reprinted in India);  
Grube-Reeve and Cooper's Complete Works (Hackett 1997); the Revised  
Oxford Translation (Barnes 1984); Ross.

WORDINGS DIFFER MARKEDLY - PREFER THE REFERENCE TO THE QUOTATION.

GREEK TERMS: give each ONCE, transliterated and glossed. Repeated  
untranslated Greek reads as decoration, not as control.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 24/25: Testimony ledger and the final trap sheet

### TESTIMONY LEDGER - REPORT AS TESTIMONY, NOT AS TEXT

|                                 |                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "THIRD MAN"                     | the ARGUMENT is Plato's at Parmenides 132a-b, where the example is largeness; the NAME comes from Aristotle's reports (Met. 990b17, 1039a2) |
| "THE MATHEMATICALS" (ta metaxu) | Aristotle's testimony at Met. I.6 (987b14); NOT stated in the dialogues -> "on Aristotle's testimony"                                       |
| "MAN IS A RATIONAL ANIMAL"      | a SCHOLASTIC formula (animal rationale) crystallised from Aristotle; not a sentence of his text                                             |
| "NATURE DOES NOTHING IN VAIN"   | De Caelo, Politics, De Partibus Animalium - safe as a maxim; name a work if you quote it                                                    |
| POPPER ON PLATO                 | The Open Society and Its Enemies, Vol. I (1945); widely regarded as polemical and contested                                                 |

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### FINAL TRAP SHEET - NEVER WRITE

|                                                                            |                                            |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| X "Plato denies the reality of the physical world"                         | -> DERIVATIVE reality                      |
| X "Forms are concepts in the mind"                                         | -> that is CONCEPTUALISM                   |
| X "Aristotle rejected forms / denies universals"                           | -> SEPARATED forms only                    |
| X Aristotle's formal cause = Plato's Form                                  | -> same word, different ontological status |
| X "The Unmoved Mover is an efficient cause"                                | -> FINAL cause; it attracts, not pushes    |
| X "Potentiality means probability"                                         | -> ontological CAPACITY                    |
| X four causes as four EVENTS or four AGENTS                                | -> aspects of ONE explanation              |
| X "primary substance" means the same in the Categories and Metaphysics VII | -> two questions, two criteria             |
| X "the form persists" said of SUBSTANTIAL change                           | -> only of ACCIDENTAL                      |
| X the Form of the Good = the Timaeus Demiurge                              | -> CONTESTED; keep apart                   |



## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 25/25: The ownership boundary and the qualified conclusion

### FINAL CONTROL - THE OWNERSHIP BOUNDARY

ANSWER THE PRINTED METAPHYSICS: Ideas; Substance; Form and Matter;  
Causation; Actuality and Potentiality.

|  
+--> NOT OWNER CONTENT UNDER THIS CLAUSE  
|     PLATO: the tripartite soul; immortality proofs beyond  
|     recollection; justice; the philosopher-ruler; education as a  
|     curriculum; the critique of democracy (Republic VIII)  
|     ARISTOTLE: the soul-faculties and the separate-intellect  
|     problem; virtue and the mean; voluntary action; flourishing;  
|     contemplation; the political animal; constitutions; the  
|     syllogistic and the rest of the logic  
|     -> these are LEGITIMATE CROSS-LINKS, but they are enrichment  
|     and must be flagged as such  
|

+--> THREE BOUNDED EXCEPTIONS THE SOURCES THEMSELVES LICENSE  
1 the soul's prior acquaintance and its capacity for NOESIS,  
   because recollection is an ARGUMENT FOR THE FORMS  
2 education as CONVERSION (periagoge) and the philosopher's  
   RETURN (katabasis), because they are the CAVE'S OWN ENDING  
3 the soul as the FORM OF THE LIVING BODY (De Anima II.1),  
   because it is Aristotle's LEADING ILLUSTRATION of  
   HYLOMORPHISM  
|

+--> BOUNDED COSMOLOGICAL QUALIFICATION: the Demiurge and the  
Receptacle enter only to prevent the false equation of the Good  
with a creator. The Unmoved Mover is retained only because pure  
actuality COMPLETES the actuality-potentiality and causal system.  
|

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### QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

Both men answer ONE question about the character of things.  
PLATO secures stability, objectivity and knowledge - and FORFEITS causation,  
   because the separation that makes a Form knowable makes it inert.  
ARISTOTLE secures causation, unity and generation - and FORFEITS a clean  
   account of universals, because Metaphysics VII (Z).13 denies substancehood  
   to the very universality that makes form intelligible.  
The unresolved remainder becomes THE PROBLEM OF UNIVERSALS, and through it  
every later realism-nominalism debate. NEITHER SIDE SETTLED IT.